Crystal Quest

Official Rules

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1. Welcome to Crystal Quest

Crystal Quest is a tactical RPG trading card game. Each player leads a party of three Heroes into battle against rival parties to defend the realm from calamity. You build a deck of spells, tactics, songs, items and equipment, then fight in rounds that move from Dawn to Dusk before your party rests in Town to heal, shop and upgrade gear.

Winning takes careful positioning, smart use of your Aura each round, and good timing with hidden cards your opponents can't see.

How to Win

Defeat all of your opponents' Heroes. A Hero is defeated when it dies. The last player with a Hero still standing wins.

The Golden Rule

If a card's text contradicts these rules, the card wins.

2. What You Need

Each player needs:

- 3 Hero cards
- A deck of exactly 30 cards
- A six-sided die for each Hero, to track its level
- Counters for damage, status effects and other effects
- A way to track Aura (a die or tokens)
- A way to track Gold (a die, tokens or coins)
- Space for a play area

The table shares one **Position marker** that shows which party position is acting (Lead, Center or Closer).

3. Building Your Party and Deck

Your Party

Choose any three Heroes. There is no limit on which classes you combine, and you may include more than one Hero of the same class.

Your party's classes decide which cards you can play. A Hero can only play cards of its own class or Generic cards. You may put any card in your deck, but a class card is stuck in your hand unless a Hero of that class can play it.

Your Deck

- Your deck is exactly 30 cards. Your three Heroes and any tokens don't count toward the 30.
- You may include up to 2 copies of any card with the same name.
- You may include only 1 copy of each Legendary card.

4. The Cards

Heroes

Heroes are your party. They start the game in play, side by side in party order, and they take almost every action (summons can also attack). Every Hero has a class and these stats:

Stat	What it does
Strength (STR)	How much damage the Hero's basic attack deals.
Defense (DEF)	Reduces the damage the Hero takes from each attack or damaging card.
Aura (A)	How much Aura the Hero adds to your Aura pool each round.
Health Points (HP)	How much damage a Hero can take before it dies.
Level (LVL)	From 0 to 6, tracked on a six-sided die. Heroes start at Level 0. Every two levels gained (at Levels 2, 4 and 6), the Hero adds +1 to STR, DEF or Aura, for up to 3 stat points.

Some Hero abilities have a **Level 3** or **Level 6** frame. Those abilities turn on, or get stronger, once the Hero reaches that level.

Spells

Single-use magic. Play it, resolve it, then put it in your discard pile.

Tactics

Single-use battle actions. They work like spells: play, resolve, discard.

Songs

A Bard card type. Songs work like spells, and many Bard cards reward you for playing, revealing or replaying Songs.

Items

Items go into your inventory slots and stay there until used or removed. Item subtypes:

- **Consumable**: used once, then exiled.
- **Relic**: stays in play and gives a lasting effect.

- **Trap**: a Hidden item that waits face down for its trigger (see Hidden Cards).
- **Arrow**: a Ranger item you activate for damage and an effect.
- **Gemstone**: a Generic item you may exile at Dawn, exhausting a Hero, for a one-time effect.
- **Precious Metal**: a Generic item (Gold, Silver or Platinum Bar) with a paid effect.

Equipment

Weapons, armor, instruments and accessories that you equip to a Hero to boost it. Equipment has one cost: its Aura cost, which you pay every time you equip it, whether from your hand, from your inventory, or by moving it to another Hero. There is no separate equip cost. Some equipment can also be upgraded with Gold at the Blacksmith. See Equipment.

Enchantments and Curses

Enchantments attach to a Hero and change it while attached. Curses are Warlock enchantments that weaken the Hero they're attached to.

Summons

Summon cards create creatures that fight for you. A summon has two numbers, written STR/HP: a 3/5 Beast has 3 STR and 5 HP. See Summons.

Tokens

Tokens are cards created by effects rather than drawn from your library, such as Pillars, Daggers and the Doll. They don't count toward your deck.

- Pillar tokens and summon tokens go on the battlefield. They don't use inventory slots.
- Equipment tokens (such as Daggers) and item tokens (such as the Doll) go into an empty inventory slot.
- A token has an Aura cost of 0 unless it says otherwise, so equipping an equipment token costs 0 Aura.
- A token that leaves play (destroyed, discarded or exiled) is removed from the game.
- **Dagger** means any equipment with "Dagger" in its name, including Dagger tokens.

Token list. Summon stats are written STR/HP.

Token	Kind	Stats	Aura to equip	Text	Made by
Dagger	Equipment (Rogue, One-Handed)	+1 STR	0	Equipped Hero gains +1 STR.	Armed, Quick Inventory, Blademaster's Choice
Viper Fang Dagger	Equipment (Rogue, One-Handed)	+1 STR	1	Equipped Hero gains +1 STR and Poisonous 1.	Ritual of Fang
Doll	Item	0 STR, 0 DEF, 5 HP	—	Takes an inventory slot. It can be targeted and dealt damage like a Hero. At 0 HP it is destroyed.	Mocking Doll

Token	Kind	Stats	Aura to equip	Text	Made by
Soldier	Summon	2/2	—		Conscript, Noble Choice, Rally the Troops
Eliazar	Summon (Soldier)	3/5	—		Sword of Eliazar
Beast	Summon	3/3	—		Beast, Out of the Woods
Heavy Beast	Summon (Beast)	4/5	—		Heavy Beast
Woods Beast	Summon (Beast)	3/5	—	When this deals damage, draw a card.	Elk of the Woods
Elk	Summon	2/2	—		Elk, Nature's Choice
Wolf	Summon	2/3	—		Wolf
Aurawing Familiar	Summon (Familiar)	3/3	—	When this is destroyed, gain 1 Aura.	Aurawing
Drawwing Familiar	Summon (Familiar)	3/3	—	When this is destroyed, draw a card.	Drawwing
Spore	Summon	0/1	—	When this is destroyed, discard a card.	Spore Calling
Spirit	Summon	2/2	—		Warden of the Woods
Spectral Elk	Summon (Spirit)	5/8	—		Verdant Sage
Spell Damage Pillar	Pillar	—	—	Your spells deal +1 damage.	Boost Ritual, Volt Jab, Lightning Lance, Lightning Rod, Ritual of Power, Chain Lightning
Pain Pillar	Pillar	—	—	At Dusk, target loses X HP, where X is the number of Pain Pillars you control.	Dark Insight, Ritual of Pain

Splitting Ritual and Doubling Ritual copy whichever Pillars you sacrifice.

Supertypes

- **Legendary**: only 1 copy allowed per deck.
- **Hidden**: played face down and triggered later. Traps and cards previously marked "Secret" are Hidden cards.

5. Areas of Play

Zone	What goes there
Party	Your three Heroes, left to right in party order.
Battlefield	Your summons and Pillar tokens.
Inventory	4 slots shared by your party, for items, Hidden cards, equipment tokens and unequipped equipment.

Zone	What goes there
Library	Your face-down draw pile. Your 30-card deck becomes your library at the start of the game.
Hand	Cards you have drawn but not yet played. There is no hand size limit.
Discard pile	Face up. Used, destroyed and discarded cards go here.
Exile zone	Face up. Cards removed from the game. Exiled cards don't come back unless a card says so.

Party Positions

Your Heroes stand in a row. The Hero furthest left is the **Lead** (Position 1), the middle Hero is the **Center** (Position 2), and the Hero on the right is the **Closer** (Position 3). Positions decide when each Hero acts during the Battle Phase. A Hero can move to the back of the line with the Step Back action.

6. Resources

Aura

Aura is the power your party channels each round. You spend it to play cards, activate abilities and equip equipment.

- At Dawn, your Aura pool refreshes to the total Aura stat of your Heroes that aren't dead.
- Pay Aura from your pool whenever you pay an Aura cost. On cards, Aura costs are shown as a number next to the Aura icon.
- Unspent Aura is lost at Dusk. It never carries over.
- If a Hero's Aura stat goes up when it levels, the extra Aura arrives at the next Dawn, not right away.

Gold

Gold is the treasure your party earns by surviving each round.

- Every player starts the game with 0 Gold.
- At Dusk, gain 1 Gold for each of your Heroes that isn't dead. Summons don't earn Gold.
- Gold carries over from round to round.
- Gold can only be spent in the Town Phase.

7. Setting Up

1. Each player places their three Heroes in the party order they choose. Every Hero starts at Level 0, so keep its level die beside it until it first levels up.
2. Shuffle your 30-card deck. It is now your library. Place it on the right side of your play area.
3. Leave room under your library for your discard pile and exile zone.
4. Set your Gold to 0.
5. Each player draws 4 cards.
6. Each player may mulligan once: shuffle your hand into your library and draw a new hand of 4.
7. Roll dice. The highest roller starts with **initiative**.

8. The Round

Crystal Quest is played in rounds. Every player goes through each round together. Cards that say "turn" mean the round. A round has four phases:

Phase	What happens
1. Dawn	Ready up, refresh Aura, take status damage, resolve "At Dawn" effects, draw a card.
2. Battle	Heroes take actions in position order until every player passes.
3. Dusk	Resolve "At Dusk" effects, end round-long effects, lose unspent Aura, collect Gold, pass initiative.
4. Town	Spend Gold at the Blacksmith, Inn and Shop, starting with the player who has initiative.

When a card says "At Dawn" or "At Dusk", it means during that phase.

Initiative and the Active Player

The player with initiative is the **active player**. Everyone else is a **passive player**. The active player takes the first action in each position, puts triggers on the stack first, and goes first in Town.

Initiative passes at the end of every Dusk Phase, so the player who receives it leads Town and then the next round.

- With two players, initiative goes to the other player.
- With more players, initiative moves clockwise.
- If a card gives a player initiative, the rotation continues from that player afterward.

1. Dawn Phase

All players do these steps together:

1. **Ready.** Ready all your exhausted cards. You may choose to keep a Meditating Hero exhausted (see Meditate).
2. **Refresh Aura.** Your Aura pool becomes the total Aura of your Heroes that aren't dead.
3. **Status damage.** Each Burned, Poisoned or Wounded counter deals 1 damage. Then remove one of each status counter from each Hero and summon.
4. **At Dawn effects.** Resolve abilities that happen "At Dawn", using the stack (see Triggers and the Stack). This is when Echo copies are played and Gemstones can be used.
5. **Draw.** Each player draws a card.

A Hero exhausted during Dawn, for example by a Gemstone, stays exhausted for the whole Battle Phase.

2. Battle Phase

This is where the fighting happens. Set the Position marker to **Lead**.

1. The active player takes one action with their Lead Hero.
2. Priority passes clockwise. Each other player takes one action with their own Lead Hero.
3. When every player has acted once with that position, move the Position marker to the next position: Lead, then Center, then Closer, then back to Lead.

4. Keep going until every player has passed.

Stand-ins. If the Hero in the marked position is exhausted or dead, the next ready Hero to its right acts instead. After the Closer, this wraps around to the Lead. If none of your Heroes are ready, you may still attack with a ready summon or surrender a dead Hero's soul; otherwise you have no action this time.

Summons. When you have priority, you may attack with a ready summon instead of taking your Hero's action.

Passing. At any time during the Battle Phase, you may say **"I pass."** You take no more actions this round, and priority skips you. Players usually pass when all their Heroes are exhausted or they choose not to act further. The Battle Phase ends when every player has passed.

3. Dusk Phase

All players do these steps together:

1. **At Dusk effects.** Resolve abilities that happen "At Dusk", such as Pain Pillars, using the stack.
2. **End effects.** Effects that last "until Dusk", "this turn" or "for the rest of the turn" end. Guard wears off.
3. **Lose Aura.** Remove all unspent Aura from your pool.
4. **Collect Gold.** Gain 1 Gold for each of your Heroes that isn't dead.
5. **Pass initiative.** Initiative passes to the next player (see Initiative and the Active Player). That player is now the active player for Town and the next round.

4. Town Phase

Your party heads into Town. The player with initiative visits first, then Town passes clockwise. On your visit, go to any location in any order, as many times as you can pay. Say "I leave Town" when you're done.

Location	Cost	What you get
Blacksmith	Upgrade cost	Upgrade one piece of your equipment (see Upgrading Equipment).
Inn	5 Gold	One of your Heroes that isn't dead heals 5 HP.
Shop	4 Gold	Draw a card.

Heroes can't heal above their maximum HP, and dead Heroes can't heal at the Inn.

9. Actions

When you have priority, you take one action with the Hero in the marked position. These are the actions a Hero can take:

Play a Card

The Hero must be ready, the card must be Generic or match the Hero's class, and you must have enough Aura.

1. Announce the card and its targets.
2. Pay its Aura cost.
3. Open a trigger window (see Triggers and the Stack).

4. Resolve as much of the card as you can.
5. Put the card in your discard pile, unless it stays in play (items, equipment, enchantments).

Playing a card doesn't exhaust the Hero unless the card says "Exhaust this Hero" or creates a summon (see Summons).

Basic Attack

1. Announce the attack and choose any target controlled by any player.
2. Exhaust the attacking Hero. (Exhausting is the cost of attacking.)
3. Open a trigger window. On-attack effects resolve here.
4. Calculate damage: the attacker's STR minus the target's DEF (see Damage).
5. Reduce the target's HP.

Activate an Ability

1. Announce the ability.
2. Pay its costs. If the cost includes "Exhaust", exhaust the Hero.
3. Open a trigger window.
4. Resolve as much of the effect as you can.

Activate an Arrow

Arrows are Ranger items in your inventory. Activating one is an action: pay its Aura cost, exhaust the Hero activating it, then resolve it like an ability. Other items with a cost (such as Gold Bar) are activated the same way, but they only exhaust a Hero if their text says so.

Level Up

1. Announce the Level action.
2. Exhaust the Hero.
3. Raise its level by 1. The first time a Hero levels (from 0 to 1), place its level die on it showing 1. After that, turn the die up by 1.
4. Draw a card.

Each Hero can level up once per round, up to Level 6. Every two levels a Hero gains (when it reaches Level 2, Level 4 and Level 6), you may add +1 to one of its stats: STR, DEF or Aura. A Hero that reaches Level 6 has gained 3 stat points. Track the bonuses with counters. STR and DEF bonuses apply immediately. An Aura bonus is added to your pool starting at the next Dawn.

Step Back

Move the Hero to the back of your party (the Closer position). The other Heroes shift left. Stepping back uses the Hero's action but doesn't exhaust it. Each Hero can step back once per Battle Phase.

Inventory Actions

- **Add to inventory:** place an item or Hidden card from your hand into an empty inventory slot, paying any cost.
- **Clear a slot:** move any card from your inventory to your discard pile.

Surrender a Soul

Instead of a Hero's action, you may surrender the soul of one of your dead Heroes for a small one-time effect. It can't be revived afterward. See Surrender Your Soul.

Equip

The acting Hero pays the equipment's Aura cost and equips it to itself: from your hand (this is playing the card), from your inventory, or by taking it from another of your Heroes. The acting Hero must match the equipment's class, or the equipment must be Generic. See Equipment for the details.

10. Hero States

A Hero is always in one of these states:

State	How it looks	What it means
Ready	Upright	Can take actions and pay Hidden card costs.
Exhausted	Turned 90° right	Can't take actions until readied.
Meditating	Exhausted	A Monk-style rest that builds power (see Meditate).
Dead	Face down	Out of the fight (see Death). Can be revived.
Surrendered	Face down, turned sideways	Dead, and its soul is gone. Can't be revived (see Surrender Your Soul).

A Hero becomes exhausted when it makes a basic attack, levels up, activates an Arrow, pays an exhaust cost, plays a card that creates a summon, or plays a card that says to exhaust it.

An exhausted Hero can't take any action: it can't play cards, activate abilities, attack, Level, Step Back or equip, and it can't be exhausted to trigger a Hidden card. Its equipment, enchantments and passive abilities (such as "While exhausted…") still work, and it can still be targeted and healed. Another Hero can take equipment from it.

11. Triggers and the Stack

The Trigger Window

Every time a player takes an action, a **trigger window** opens after the action is announced and its costs are paid. Any triggered abilities and Hidden cards that respond to that action resolve in this window, **before** the action itself resolves.

Some triggers react to something that happens **while** an action resolves, such as "When a Hero dies" or "Whenever this Hero deals damage". These go on the stack right after that event happens, once the action has finished resolving.

The Stack

When several abilities trigger at the same time (in a trigger window, at Dawn or at Dusk), they go on the **stack**:

1. The active player puts all of their triggered abilities on the stack, in any order they choose, and chooses targets.
2. Then each passive player, clockwise, does the same.
3. Resolve the stack from the top down. The last ability added resolves first.

Example: at Dusk, the active player has a Pain Pillar and the passive player has Tome of Gim. The active player's Pain Pillar goes on the stack first, then Tome of Gim goes on top. Tome of Gim resolves first, then the Pain Pillar.

12. Hidden Cards

Hidden cards are your surprises. Traps and cards previously marked "Secret" are Hidden cards.

Setting a Hidden Card

As an action, place a Hidden card face down in an empty inventory slot. It waits there until its trigger condition happens.

Triggering a Hidden Card

When the card's trigger happens, its owner may reveal it in the trigger window:

1. Announce the trigger.
2. Exhaust a ready Hero of the card's class. For a Generic Hidden card, any ready Hero will do.
3. Pay all other costs.
4. Turn the card face up.
5. Resolve its effect.
6. Follow the card's instructions afterward (usually discard it).

You must have a ready Hero to trigger a Hidden card. If all your matching Heroes are exhausted or dead, you can't trigger it. A Hidden card resolves before the action that triggered it.

13. Damage, Healing and Death

Damage

Damage dealt = STR (for attacks) or the card's damage amount (for cards) – the target's DEF. Damage can't go below 0.

- **Guard X** absorbs the first X damage before DEF is applied.
- **Piercing X** ignores X points of the target's DEF.
- **Spell Damage +X** adds X to the damage your spells deal.
- **Status damage** from Burned, Poisoned and Wounded ignores DEF and Guard.
- **"Lose X HP"** isn't damage. It ignores DEF and Guard.

On-hit effects that apply a status still apply, even if DEF reduces the damage to 0. If an effect depends on "damage dealt", use the damage after DEF.

Example: a Hero with 5 STR attacks a Hero with 2 DEF and Guard 1. Guard absorbs 1 (leaving 4), then DEF reduces it by 2. The target takes 2 damage.

Healing

HP never heals on its own. Heroes heal only from cards, abilities and the Inn. A Hero can't heal above its maximum HP, which includes level bonuses.

Death

When a Hero reaches 0 HP it **dies**. Turn it face down. A dead Hero:

- Can't act, and is skipped in the action order
- Doesn't add Aura or earn Gold
- Can't be healed
- Can be brought back by revive effects

Party order stays the same while a Hero is dead.

Equipment on a dead Hero. When a Hero dies, all of its equipment goes to its owner's inventory as part of the death. If there aren't enough empty slots, the owner chooses which cards to discard, from the incoming equipment and the cards already in inventory, until everything left fits. Enchantments and curses on a dead Hero are discarded. "When a Hero dies" triggers resolve after this, so the equipment is already in inventory when they resolve, unless a card says it replaces this step.

Surrender Your Soul

A dead Hero's soul can still help your party. When you have priority during the Battle Phase, instead of taking a Hero's action, you may **surrender the soul** of one of your dead Heroes. Choose one:

- Draw a card.
- Gain 2 Aura.
- Target ally gains +2 STR this turn.
- Deal 2 damage to any target.
- Gain 3 Gold.
- Target ally gains +2 DEF this turn.

If you surrender a Hero's soul, it can't be revived. Leave it face down and turn it sideways to show its soul is gone. It stays in its position, so party order doesn't change, and it's skipped like any dead Hero.

- Surrendering a soul uses your priority like an action, but no Hero takes it and no one is exhausted. A trigger window opens as usual.
- Surrendering a soul isn't a card or ability, so it can't be canceled. Its effect can still be prevented like any other (for example, damage prevention).
- Each dead Hero's soul can be surrendered only once.
- The 2 damage works like card damage: the target's Guard and DEF apply.
- Aura gained this way is lost at Dusk like any other Aura. Gold gained this way can be spent in the next Town Phase.
- A surrendered Hero still counts as dead for winning and losing.

Revival

A revive effect brings a dead Hero back to life. The card says how much HP it returns with and whether it is ready or exhausted. A revived Hero comes back with no equipment. Its old equipment stays in inventory and costs its Aura cost to equip again. A Hero whose soul was surrendered can't be revived.

14. Summons

- **Summoning exhausts.** Playing a card that creates a summon, including cards that copy or duplicate summons, exhausts the Hero that played it, whether or not the card says "Exhaust this Hero." A summon created by a triggered effect (such as when a card is destroyed or a Hero dies) doesn't exhaust anyone.
- Summons enter the battlefield exhausted. They ready at Dawn like your other cards.
- A summon that attacks becomes exhausted.
- When you have priority, a ready summon may attack instead of your Hero's action. Summons aren't tied to a position.
- Summons can't be equipped and don't earn Gold.
- At 0 HP a summon dies and is **destroyed**. Unlike Heroes, destroyed summons can't be revived.
- "Ally" and "friendly" include your summons as well as your Heroes.

15. Status Effects and Counters

Status Counters

There are five status counters. At Dawn, each damaging status deals its damage, then one of each status counter is removed from each Hero and summon.

Status	Effect
Burned	Deals 1 damage at Dawn.
Poisoned	Deals 1 damage at Dawn.
Wounded	Deals 1 damage at Dawn.
Confused	The Hero's attacks and the targets of its cards and abilities are chosen at random from all legal targets, including allies.
Stunned	The Hero can't activate abilities or play cards. It can still attack, equip from inventory and move equipment.

Other Counters

Some cards use other counters, such as +1/+1 counters, Petal counters and Campfire counters. These aren't status counters, so they aren't removed at Dawn. Each card explains how its counters work.

16. Equipment

Equipping puts a piece of equipment on a Hero. **Pay the equipment's Aura cost every time you equip it.** There is no separate equip cost.

The Hero receiving the equipment always takes the action and pays. It must be ready and able to use the equipment, so class only has to be checked on one Hero. A Hero can't equip gear to another Hero unless a card says so (such as Quick Change).

Equipping From Your Hand

Equipping from your hand is playing the card. The Hero playing it pays its Aura cost and equips it to itself.

Equipping From Your Inventory

As an action, a Hero pays the equipment's Aura cost and equips a piece of equipment from your inventory to itself. A Stunned Hero can do this, because it isn't playing a card.

Moving Equipment

As an action, a Hero pays the equipment's Aura cost and takes a piece of equipment from another of your Heroes, equipping it to itself. The Hero giving up the piece doesn't act and can be exhausted. Moving doesn't count as unequipping, and the equipment keeps its upgrade. A Stunned Hero can do this. A card that moves equipment "without paying its Aura cost" (such as Quick Change) skips the payment and follows the card's text for who gets it.

Who Can Use Equipment

- Equipment with a class can only go on a Hero of that class. Generic equipment can go on any Hero.
- Because the receiving Hero takes the action, equipment normally goes only on a ready Hero. A card can put equipment on an exhausted Hero. Equipment never goes on a dead Hero.
- Requirements printed on the equipment (such as "Must be Level 1 to equip") are checked every time it's equipped, including when it's moved or equipped from inventory. Once it's on the Hero, it stays there even if the Hero stops meeting the requirement.

Costs That Change

- Effects that make equipment cost more or less (such as Blessed Champion) apply every time you equip it, whether from your hand, from your inventory or by moving it.
- A cost can't go below 0.
- An equipment token has an Aura cost of 0, so equipping it is free.
- "Equip … for free" or "without paying its Aura cost" means you pay nothing for that equip.

Equipment Regions

Each Hero has these regions. Only one piece of equipment can fill each region.

Region	Examples
Head	Helms, headbands
Chest	Chest plates
Arms	Arm guards, vambraces
Hands (2)	One-Handed weapons use one Hand. Two-Handed weapons and instruments use both.
Legs	Greaves
Feet	Boots
Accessory	Rings, quivers

Replacing Equipment

If the region is already filled, the old piece moves to your inventory when the new piece is equipped. A Two-Handed piece replaces everything in both Hands, and a One-Handed piece equipped to a Hero holding a Two-Handed piece replaces that Two-Handed piece. If there isn't room in your inventory, you choose which cards to discard (see Inventory Overflow).

Unequipping

Unequipped equipment goes to your inventory. This happens when a card unequips it (such as Disarm or Hand to Hand Combat), when it's replaced, or when its Hero dies. Equipment in your inventory gives no bonus until it's equipped again, at its full Aura cost.

Inventory Overflow

Whenever more cards need to go into your inventory than you have empty slots, you choose which cards to discard, from the incoming cards and the cards already there, until everything left fits. This applies to replaced equipment, unequipped equipment and equipment from a Hero that dies.

Upgrading Equipment

Some equipment has a **Gold Upgrade Cost** and an **Upgrade** effect. At the Blacksmith in Town, pay the upgrade cost to upgrade it:

- The equipment can be on a Hero or in your inventory.
- Put an upgrade counter on it. Its Upgrade effect is now active.
- Each piece can be upgraded once.
- It keeps its upgrade when moved between Heroes, sent to your inventory, or taken from a Hero that died. It loses its upgrade if it leaves play (discarded, destroyed or exiled). Equipment in your inventory is still in play.

17. Keywords

Keyword	Meaning
Banding	Lets Heroes and summons group together for one attack. When a Hero or summon with Banding attacks, any number of other ready friendly Heroes and summons with Banding may join it. Add their STR to the attack, then exhaust every attacker. Nothing has Banding naturally; only cards grant it.
Combo	When a Combo card is played, reveal the top card of your library. If its subtype is Combo, you may play it, or a Combo card from your hand, by paying its Aura cost. This doesn't use another action.
Conjure	Create a Pillar token on the battlefield.
Echo	At your next Dawn, play this card again for free (no Aura cost). Any of your Heroes of the card's class plays the copy, and you may choose new targets. The copy doesn't have Echo, so it only repeats once. Set the card aside until then, and discard it after.
Enraged	A Hero is Enraged while it is at or below half its maximum HP.
Guard X	Absorbs the first X damage that would be dealt to this Hero, before DEF. Wears off at Dusk.
Harmonize X	Exhaust X ready Heroes you control to gain the effect after the colon.
Lifelink	When this Hero deals damage, heal it that much.
Meditate	Exhaust this Hero. It is now Meditating. At each Dawn, you may keep it exhausted. If you do, it gets a +1/+1 counter. When it readies, it stops Meditating, and all its +1/+1 counters (including any from Monk Tactics) are removed at the next Dusk.
Mill X	Put the top X cards of a library into its owner's discard pile.
Pain Pillar	At Dusk, target loses X HP, where X is the number of Pain Pillars you control.
Piercing X	This attack ignores X points of the target's DEF.
Poisonous X	Whenever this Hero deals damage, add X Poison counters to the target if it has none.
Scry X	Look at the top X cards of your library. Put any number on the bottom and the rest back on top in any order.
Spell Damage +X	Your spells deal X extra damage.
Spell Damage Pillar	Each one you control gives your spells +1 Spell Damage.
Stealth	This Hero can't be targeted by enemy attacks, cards or abilities.
+1/+1 counter	+1 STR and +1 DEF while on the Hero.

Damage types. Fire, Ice, Lightning, Light and Dark damage work like normal damage for now. They will matter in a future update.

18. Other Rules

Drawing From an Empty Library

If you need to draw and your library is empty, shuffle your discard pile to make a new library and keep drawing.

Card Text Terms

- **"This turn"** and **"for the rest of the turn"** mean until Dusk this round.
- **"Ally"** and **"friendly"** mean anything you control, including summons. **"Enemy"** and **"opposing"** mean anything an opponent controls.
- **"Destroy"** puts a card in play into its owner's discard pile. **"Exile"** removes it to the exile zone.
- **"Sacrifice"** means destroy one of your own cards as a cost.
- **"Non-Hero object"** means any card in play that isn't a Hero.
- **"Attach an Equipment"** on older cards means equip it.

19. Example Round

Ava (with initiative) and Ben each have three Heroes. Ava's party: a Paladin (Lead), a Mage (Center) and a Rogue (Closer). Ben's party: a Barbarian, a Cleric and a Ranger.

Dawn. Both players ready their cards. Ava's Heroes have 1, 2 and 1 Aura, so her pool is 4. Ben's Ranger has a Poison counter, so it takes 1 damage, and the counter comes off. Both players draw.

Battle, Lead. The marker is on Lead. Ava's Paladin plays Extra Protection (Guard 1 until Dusk) and stays ready. Ben's Barbarian makes a basic attack on Ava's Mage: 4 STR – 1 DEF = 3 damage. The Barbarian exhausts.

Battle, Center. The marker moves to Center. Ava's Mage casts a spell that deals 4 damage to Ben's Barbarian, which has 1 DEF, so it takes 3. Ben's Cleric heals his Barbarian for 3.

Battle, Closer. Ava's Rogue sets a Hidden card face down in her inventory. Ben's Ranger activates an Arrow at Ava's Rogue. In the trigger window, Ava reveals her Hidden card, exhausting her ready Rogue to pay for it, and prevents the damage.

Battle, Lead again. The marker returns to Lead. Ava's Paladin is still ready and attacks. Ben's Barbarian is exhausted, so his next ready Hero to the right, the Cleric, stands in. Then both players pass.

Dusk. Guard wears off, unspent Aura is lost, and each player gains 3 Gold, one for each Hero still standing. Finally, initiative passes from Ava to Ben.

Town. Ben now has initiative, so he visits first. With only 3 Gold, neither player can afford the Shop (4) or the Inn (5) yet, so both save their Gold. A new round begins with Ben as the active player.

20. Glossary

Quick definitions of the terms used in these rules and on cards, grouped by topic.

Game structure

- **Round**: One full cycle of play: Dawn, Battle, Dusk, Town. On cards, "turn" means round. Effects that last "this turn" end at Dusk.
- **Phase**: One part of a round: Dawn, Battle, Dusk, Town.

- **Dawn Phase**: First phase of a round. Ready cards, refresh Aura, take status damage, resolve "At Dawn" effects, draw a card.
- **Battle Phase**: Second phase. Heroes act in position order, using the Position marker, until every player passes.
- **Dusk Phase**: Third phase. Resolve "At Dusk" effects, end round-long effects, lose unspent Aura, collect Gold, then pass initiative.
- **Town Phase (Enter Town)**: Each player may spend Gold at the Blacksmith, Inn and Shop. The player with initiative goes first.
- **Blacksmith**: Town location. Pay an equipment's Gold Upgrade Cost to turn on its Upgrade effect. Once per piece.
- **Inn**: Town location. 5 Gold: one Hero that isn't dead heals 5 HP.
- **Shop**: Town location. 4 Gold: draw a card.
- **Initiative**: Who acts first. Set by a die roll at setup, then passed at the end of each Dusk Phase: to the other player (2 players) or clockwise (multiplayer). The player who receives it goes first in Town and in the next round.
- **Priority**: The right to take the next action. Starts with the initiative player and passes clockwise after each action.
- **Party order / Position**: Left-to-right order of your Heroes: Lead (Position 1), Center (2), Closer (3).
- **I pass**: A declaration during the Battle Phase. You take no more actions and priority skips you. The Battle Phase ends when everyone has passed.
- **Mulligan**: Once at setup, shuffle your hand into your library and draw a new hand of four.
- **Active player**: The player with initiative. Acts first in each position, stacks triggers first, and visits Town first.
- **Passive player**: Any player without initiative.
- **Position marker**: Shared marker showing which position (Lead, Center or Closer) is acting.
- **Stand-in**: If the marked Hero is exhausted or dead, the next ready Hero to its right acts, wrapping from Closer to Lead.
- **At Dawn / At Dusk**: During the Dawn Phase / Dusk Phase.

Heroes and stats

- **Hero**: One of your three characters, and the card type.
- **Party**: Your three Heroes together.
- **Ally / Friendly**: Anything you control, including summons. "Enemy" and "opposing" mean controlled by an opponent.
- **Class**: A Hero's role: Barbarian, Bard, Cleric, Druid, Mage, Monk, Paladin, Ranger, Rogue, Warlock. A Hero plays only Generic cards and cards of its class.
- **Generic**: A card or equipment any class can use.
- **Strength (STR)**: Attack power.
- **Defense (DEF)**: Reduces incoming damage.
- **Aura (A)**: The Hero's contribution to your Aura pool each round.
- **Health Points (HP)**: How much damage a Hero can take before it dies.
- **Level (LVL)**: 0 to 6, tracked on a six-sided die. Heroes start at Level 0. The Level action raises it by 1.
- **Level bonus**: Every two levels gained (at Levels 2, 4 and 6), add +1 to STR, DEF or Aura, for up to 3 stat points. Aura bonuses start at the next Dawn.
- **Level 3 / Level 6 frame**: Marks a Hero ability that turns on or improves at that level.
- **Defender / Defending target**: The Hero or summon being attacked or dealt damage.

Resources

- **Aura**: Main resource. Pays to play cards, activate abilities and equip equipment.
- **Aura pool**: The total of your Heroes' Aura stats, not counting dead Heroes. It refreshes each Dawn Phase and empties in the Dusk Phase.
- **Aura cost**: What a card or ability costs to play. On cards it is shown as a number plus the Aura icon. For equipment, it's also what you pay each time you equip it.
- **Gain Aura**: Add Aura to your pool right away. (Older cards say "generate".)
- **Gold**: Second resource. Earned in the Dusk Phase (1 per living Hero), kept between rounds, spent only in the Town Phase.
- **Gold Upgrade Cost**: Gold paid at the Blacksmith to upgrade a piece of equipment.

Card types and zones

- **Spell**: Single-use magic. Resolves, then goes to the discard pile.
- **Tactic**: Single-use action card. Resolves, then goes to the discard pile.
- **Song**: Bard card type. Several Bard cards return, reveal or replay Songs.
- **Item**: Card kept in an inventory slot. Subtypes: Consumable, Relic, Trap, Arrow, Gemstone, Precious Metal.
- **Consumable**: Item used once, then exiled.
- **Relic**: Item that stays in play with a lasting effect.
- **Trap**: A Hidden card with the subtype Trap.
- **Arrow**: Ranger item. Activating it is an action: pay its Aura cost and exhaust the Hero.
- **Gemstone**: Generic item you may exile at Dawn, exhausting a Hero, for a one-time effect. That Hero sits out the Battle Phase.
- **Precious Metal**: Generic item (Gold, Silver, Platinum Bar) with a paid effect.
- **Equipment**: Card that boosts a Hero while equipped. Subtypes: Armor, Weapon, Instrument, Accessory.
- **Equipment region**: Where equipment is worn: Head, Chest, Arms, Hands, Legs, Feet, Accessory. One piece per region.
- **One-Handed / Two-Handed**: How many hands a weapon or instrument uses. A Hero has two hands.
- **Enchantment**: Card attached to a Hero that changes it. Card text says "Enchanted ally".
- **Curse**: Enchantment subtype (Warlock) that weakens the Hero it's attached to.
- **Summon**: Card type that creates a creature, and the creature itself. Playing a summon card exhausts the Hero that played it. A summon has STR/HP, enters exhausted, can attack whenever you have priority, can't be equipped. At 0 HP it dies and is destroyed. It can't be revived.
- **Token**: A card created by an effect. Pillars and summons go on the battlefield. Equipment and item tokens (Dagger, Viper Fang Dagger, Doll) take an inventory slot. A token's Aura cost is 0 unless it says otherwise (Viper Fang Dagger costs 1 to equip). Tokens that leave play are removed from the game. See the token list in The Cards.
- **Hidden**: Supertype. Set face down in an inventory slot as an action. To trigger it, exhaust a ready Hero of its class (any Hero for Generic) and pay its cost. Resolves before the action that triggered it.
- **Legendary**: Supertype. Only 1 copy per deck.
- **Inventory slot**: One of 4 shared slots for items, Hidden cards, equipment tokens and unequipped equipment.
- **Inventory overflow**: When more cards must go into your inventory than you have room for, you choose which to discard.
- **Deck**: The 30 cards you build before a game (deck construction).
- **Library**: Your draw pile during play.

- **Hand**: Cards drawn but not yet played.
- **Discard pile**: Where used cards go. Reshuffled into a new library when the library runs out.
- **Exile zone**: Cards removed from the game.
- **Non-Hero object**: Any card in play that isn't a Hero (items, equipment, summons, enchantments, tokens).
- **Battlefield**: Where summons and Pillar tokens sit.

Actions and states

- **Action**: One thing a ready Hero does when you have priority: play a card, activate an ability, basic attack, level, step back, add to or remove from inventory, equip.
- **Ready**: Upright. The Hero can act.
- **Exhausted**: Turned 90° right. The Hero can't take any action (including playing cards and equipping) until readied. Some players call this "tapped".
- **Exhaust (as a cost)**: "Exhaust:" before an ability means turn the Hero sideways to use it.
- **Basic attack**: Choose any target, resolve on-attack triggers, exhaust, calculate damage, set HP.
- **Combat damage**: Damage dealt by an attack.
- **Level (action)**: Exhaust the Hero, raise its level by 1, draw a card. Once per round, max Level 6.
- **Step Back**: Action. Move the Hero to the Closer position. Doesn't exhaust. Once per Hero per Battle Phase.
- **Equip**: A Hero pays the equipment's Aura cost and puts it on itself, whether it comes from your hand, your inventory, or another of your Heroes. The receiving Hero always takes the action. Equipment has no separate equip cost.
- **Unequip**: Take equipment off a Hero. It goes to your inventory.
- **Attach**: Put an enchantment or curse onto a Hero. On older cards, "attach an Equipment" means equip it.
- **Activate**: Use an ability or item. Activating an Arrow exhausts the Hero.
- **Trigger**: A condition that sets off an ability or Hidden card ("Whenever…", "When…", "At Dawn").
- **Resolve**: Carry out a card's effect as fully as possible.
- **Cancel**: Stop a card, ability or attack from resolving.
- **Prevent**: Stop damage or an attack from happening.
- **Ignore DEF**: The attack's damage isn't reduced by the target's DEF.
- **Destroy**: Put a card in play into its owner's discard pile.
- **Exile**: Remove a card from the game to the exile zone.
- **Sacrifice**: Destroy one of your own cards as a cost.
- **Draw / Discard**: Take the top card of your library into hand / put a card from hand into the discard pile.
- **Reveal**: Show cards from your library to all players.
- **Mill X**: Put the top X cards of a library into the discard pile.
- **Scry X**: Look at the top X cards of your library. Put any number on the bottom and the rest back on top in any order.
- **Duplicate**: Make a copy of a card or summon.
- **Choose two**: Pick two of the listed effects.
- **X**: A number chosen by the player or set by the card.
- **Trigger window**: Opens after an action is announced and paid for. Triggered abilities and Hidden cards resolve here, before the action.
- **Stack**: Where simultaneous triggers wait. Active player adds first, then passive players clockwise. Resolve top down.
- **Damage**: STR or the card's damage amount minus the target's DEF, minimum 0. Status damage and "lose X HP" ignore DEF and Guard.

- **Lose X HP**: HP loss that isn't damage. Ignores DEF and Guard.

Statuses, death and summons

- **Status counter**: Burned, Poisoned, Wounded, Confused or Stunned. One of each is removed each Dawn Phase. Status damage ignores DEF and Guard. +1/+1, Petal and Campfire counters are not status counters.
- **Burned**: Status. 1 damage each Dawn Phase.
- **Poisoned**: Status. 1 damage each Dawn Phase. Cards add "Poison counters".
- **Wounded**: Status. 1 damage each Dawn Phase. Cards say "wound that target".
- **Confused**: Status. The Hero's attacks and targets are random.
- **Stunned**: Status. The Hero can't activate abilities or play cards. It can still attack and equip from inventory. Cards say "Stun".
- **Dies / Dead**: At 0 HP a Hero dies and is turned face down. Its equipment goes to your inventory. It can't act, make Aura, earn Gold or be healed until revived.
- **Heal**: Restore HP, never above max. Only from cards, abilities or the Inn.
- **Revive**: Bring a dead Hero back to life. The card says how much HP and whether it is ready. It returns with no equipment. A surrendered Hero can't be revived.
- **Surrender your soul**: Instead of a Hero's action, turn a dead Hero sideways to choose one: draw a card; gain 2 Aura; target ally +2 STR this turn; deal 2 damage; gain 3 Gold; or target ally +2 DEF this turn. That Hero can't be revived. Once per dead Hero.
- **Surrendered**: A dead Hero whose soul was surrendered. Face down and sideways. Still counts as dead.
- **STR/HP (e.g. 3/3)**: Shorthand for a summon's Strength and Health.
- **Summon types**: Named creatures from cards: Beast, Elk, Familiar, Soldier, Spirit, Spore, Wolf. See the token list in The Cards for every summon's STR/HP.
- **Damage types**: Fire, Ice, Lightning, Light and Dark appear on cards. They have no rules effect yet but will later.

Card keywords

- **Combo (Monk)**: When a Combo card is played, reveal the top card of your library. If it's a Combo card, you may play it or a Combo card from your hand, paying its Aura cost.
- **Petal counter (Monk)**: Added to Petal Shrine each time Combo triggers. At 3, the next Combo card costs 1 less.
- **Meditate / Meditating (Monk)**: Exhaust the Hero; it's Meditating. At each Dawn you may keep it exhausted and give it a +1/+1 counter. When it readies, its counters come off at the next Dusk.
- **+1/+1 counter (Monk)**: +1 STR and +1 DEF. Meditating Heroes gain them, and some Monk Tactics add more.
- **Piercing X (Monk)**: The attack ignores X points of the target's DEF.
- **Echo (Bard)**: At your next Dawn, play the card again for free. You may choose new targets.
- **Harmonize X (Bard)**: Exhaust X ready Heroes to gain the effect after the colon.
- **Guard X (Paladin)**: Absorbs the first X damage that would be dealt to this Hero, before DEF is applied. Wears off in the Dusk Phase.
- **Poisonous X (Rogue)**: Whenever this Hero deals damage, add X Poison counters to the target if it has none.
- **Stealth (Rogue)**: This Hero can't be targeted by enemy attacks, cards or abilities.
- **Lifelink (Cleric)**: When this Hero deals damage, heal it that much.
- **Enraged (Barbarian)**: A Hero is Enraged while at or below half its max HP. Some Barbarian abilities only work while Enraged.
- **Conjure (Mage, Warlock)**: Create a Pillar token in play.
- **Banding (Druid)**: Granted by cards only. Heroes and summons with Banding can attack together: add their STR, then exhaust them all.

- **Pillar (Mage, Warlock)**: Token type made by Conjure. Rituals can sacrifice, double and destroy any Pillar.
- **Spell Damage +X (Mage)**: Spells deal X extra damage.
- **Spell Damage Pillar (Mage)**: Pillar token. Each one gives your spells +1 Spell Damage.
- **Pain Pillar (Warlock)**: At Dusk, target loses X HP, where X is the number of Pain Pillars you control.